

# EMMA RACKSTRAW

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## PERSONAL INFORMATION

Email: [erackst1@swarthmore.edu](mailto:erackst1@swarthmore.edu)

Citizenship: USA

## ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

- Assistant Professor of Economics, Swarthmore College, August 2025–Present
- SSRC Criminal Justice Innovation Postdoctoral Fellow, Quattrone Center at UPenn Carey Law, 2024–5

## EDUCATION

- Harvard University, Ph.D. in Public Policy (Economics Track), 2024
- Wellesley College, B.A. in Economics (Major) and Music (Minor), 2014

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor economics, crime, discrimination, experiments, behavioral economics

## PUBLICATIONS

Opoku-Agyeman, Anna Gifty, and Emma Rackstraw. 2026. “Belief Updating, Observability, and Race in the Labor Market.” *AEA Papers and Proceedings* 116: 422–425. Available at [AEAWeb](#).

## WORKING PAPERS

When Reality TV Creates Reality: How “Copaganda” Affects Police, Communities, and Viewers. Revise and Resubmit at *Journal of Public Economics*. Available at [SSRN](#).

Bias-Motivated Updating in the Labor Market. Available at [SSRN](#).

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

Background Check Adjudication & Fair Chance Hiring. (with Amanda Agan & David Autor)

Sticky Stereotypes: Manager Identity & the Workplace. (with Anna Gifty Opoku-Agyeman)

Insurance & Hiring Returning Citizens. (with Zach Porreca & Diogo Britto)

## FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

- 2026: Arnold Ventures Planning Grant
- 2025: Tri-Co Philly Engagement Grant, Swarthmore Faculty Research Grant, J-PAL Social Policy Research Initiative\*, Russell Sage Foundation\*
- 2024: Center for Black Entrepreneurship Research Fellowship\*
- 2023: Program in Criminal Justice Grantee, Stone Program in Wealth Distribution Inequality and Social Policy Research Grantee, Institute for Quantitative Social Science Grantee, Academy of Management Doctoral Consortium Scholarship, Women and Public Policy Program Grantee\*
- 2021: ReSTAT Research Grantee, Mind Brain Behavior Initiative Grantee
- 2020: HKS Wiener Center for Social Policy Pilot Grantee; Peggy Howard Fellowship for Graduate Study in Economics; Radcliffe Engaged Summer Grantee
- 2019: National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program
- 2014: Natalie Bolton Faculty Prize in International Economics; Phi Beta Kappa

\*Based at Co-author PI Institution

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

**Affiliations:** J-PAL NA Invited Researcher

### Invited Seminars:

- 2026: Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia
- 2025: Lafayette College
- 2024: Minneapolis Fed Opportunity & Inclusive Growth Initiative (OIGI), Penn Criminology Colloquium, Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE)
- 2023: HKS Economics and Social Policy, Wellesley Initiative for Scholars of Economics (WISE)

### External Conferences and Workshops:

- 2026: National Bureau of Economic Research Summer Institute (NBERSI), American Economic Association Meeting (AEA)\*, Opportunity Insights\*, Liberal Arts College Public & Labor (LAC-PaL)
- 2025: J-PAL NA Convening on Effective US Crime Policy, Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars (Co-Organizer), Quattrone Center Spring Symposium, American Economic Association Meeting (AEA)
- 2024: Society of Labor Economists (SOLE)\*, Liberal Arts College Public & Labor (LAC-PaL), National Bureau of Economic Research Summer Institute (NBERSI), SABE-IAREP, Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime (TWECC)\*, PPE Society, American Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM)\*
- 2023: AEA, Western Economic Association International Meeting (WEAI), NBERSI, Academy of Management Meeting (AoM), APPAM
- 2022: Texas Economics of Crime Workshop (TxECW)
- 2019: Association of American Law Schools (AALS)
- 2018: APPAM

\*Co-Author Presenting

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

**Referee Service:** American Economic Review, Quarterly Journal of Economics, The Review of Economics & Statistics, American Economic Journal: Applied, Journal of Public Economics, Management Science, Journal of Policy Analysis & Management, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Justice Quarterly, Journal of Criminal Justice.

**Professional Service Positions:** Scientific Committee of the Liberal Arts College Public & Labor (LAC-PaL) Conference (2025–6), Faculty Co-Advisor of Coordinators of Community Building Events in Economics (2025–6), Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars Co-Organizer (2024–5), Kennedy School PhD Students' Association President (2021–2), PhD Peer Mentor (2020–4), HKS Anti-Racism in Economics Founding Member (2020–2), Organizer of Economics of Discrimination Reading Group (2020–1)

## TEACHING

**Teaching Interests:** Labor Economics, Economics of Crime, Microeconomics, Econometrics, Experimental Economics, Academic Writing, Causal Inference, Discrimination

### Teaching Experience:

- Introduction to Economics, Swarthmore College, 2026
- Economics of Crime & Justice, Swarthmore College, 2025–6
- Empirical Methods II for MPPs, Harvard Kennedy School, 2021
- Evaluation Course for Chief Evaluation Officers, Office of Evaluation Sciences, 2019
- Executive Education Course in Randomized Evaluation, J-PAL at MIT, 2019

## PREVIOUS EMPLOYMENT

- Research Consultant
  - PDQuery (unpaid), 2022–2024
  - Crime and Justice Policy Lab, University of Pennsylvania, 2021–2024
  - Everytown for Gun Safety, 2018–19
- Associate Fellow (Academic IPA), Office of Evaluation Sciences, 2019
- Senior Policy Associate, J-PAL North America at MIT, 2016–2019
- Research Economist, Council of Economic Advisers at the White House, 2014–2016

## SKILLS

**Data & Software:** Stata (Advanced), R (Proficient), L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X (Proficient), Zotero (Proficient), Excel (Proficient), Python (Basic)

**Languages:** English (Native), French (Proficient), Spanish (Basic)

**Talents:** Singing (Semi-Professional), Glassblowing (Amateur)

## COMMUNITY SERVICE

Prison Volunteer in PA (2022–present) and MA (2017–2020), Providence Animal Center Volunteer (2025–present), Morris Animal Refuge Volunteer (2022–2025), Meals on Wheels Volunteer (2020–2023)